



Emergency Department (ED) Primary Mental Health Stream (PMHS) SOP

Scope

Site	Department, division or operational area	Applicable to
Royal Perth Hospital (RPH) only	Emergency Department (ED)	All Staff

Purpose

This standard operational procedure (SOP) aims to outline the PMHS pathway for patients presenting to the RPH ED with isolated mental health complaints and presenting as either Australasian Triage Scale (ATS) of 4 or 5. This pathway utilises the Provisional Primary Mental Health Screening (PPMHS) Tool to expediate suitable patients to psychiatric assessment in the ED and reduce wait times.

Links within document

- [Appendix I: Primary Mental Health Stream Flow Chart](#)

Scope

Patients presenting to the ED with a primary mental health complaint and who:

- Are triaged as ATS 4 and 5 – refer [ED Triage and Waiting Room SOP](#)
- Meet the criteria on the Provisional Primary Mental Health Streaming (PPMHS) Tool

Hours of operation

The PMHS pathway will operate during times when there is double Psychiatry Liaison Nurse (PLN) from 13:00-21:30hrs.

Process

For process see [Appendix I](#).

Governance

Patients in the PMHS are under the governance of the ED – refer [Inpatient Admissions from the ED Policy](#). Patients are streamed to facilitate early review and disposition by the mental health team.

If the Psychiatry Liaison Nurse (PLN) has any concerns about the patients, they will liaise with the Emergency Physician in Charge (EPiC), ED Clinical Nurse Specialist Flow or Psychiatry Register depending on the nature of the concern.

For all patients discharged from the ED via the PMHS the PLN will discuss the case and plan with the EPiC and provide written confirmation of decision as appropriate.

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Roles and responsibilities

Triage Nurse

- Triage of all patients presenting to the ED as per the ATS
- Collaboratively completes the PPMHS Tool with the WR Nurse for all patients who present with a primary mental health condition and are triaged as an ATS 4 or 5
- Allocates patients who meet the inclusion criteria on the PMHS using the Nurse section in the EDIS Clinical Window (Figure 1) and applies an ED Team colour to the patient (Yellow/Red)
- Contacts PLN via phone – 0481 058578 (share role with WR nurse)
- Advises EPiC of patient on the PMHS.

Psychiatry Liaison Nurse (PLN)

- Reviews EDIS tracking screen to identify patients who have been screened by the Triage Nurse/WR Nurse as suitable for the PMHS. The PLN may also receive phone referrals from the Triage Nurse/Waiting Room (WR) Nurse for the PMHS
- Enters time seen and 'Z_PSYCHIATRY TEAM' into Treat Dr sections in EDIS Clinical Window (Figure 1)
- Undertakes initial Mental Health review of patients
- Completes WebPSOLIS Triage documentation and provides a printed copy to ED Clerk to file in medical records
- Make an initial assessment as to whether the patient requires mental health admission/discharge or requires ED input
- Discusses all patients with Psychiatric Registrar, collaboratively determines diagnosis and documents a joint plan
- Enters diagnosis on EDIS Clinical Window following discussion with Psychiatry Registrar
- Communicates a brief synopsis and plan to the EPiC for patients being discharged through EDIS comments
- Attains EPiC co-sign off of the WEB PSOLIS Triage documentation as evidence of discussion
- Attains EPiC or ED medical support to prescribe any medications required for patients being discharged
- Organises follow-up in the community with relevant services with support of other staff as needed (e.g. Social Work).

Treat Dr	Time Seen	Date Seen
Senior Doctor	Time Seen	Date Seen
Nurse	Nurse Time	Nurse Date

Clinical Window

Z_PSYCHIATRY
TEAM

. MHSTREAM

Treat Dr 'button' Nurse 'button'

Figure 1. Screenshot of PMHS in the Nurse Column and Treat Dr sections in EDIS Clinical Window

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Roles and responsibilities cont'd

Psychiatry Registrar

- Undertakes Mental Health review and supports PLN by providing input into determination of patient diagnosis and admission/discharge plan
- Undertakes medication review.

Resident Medical Officer (RMO) – only for inpatient admissions

***Note: for admissions into the EMW, this responsibility sits with the EMW RMO and for Mental Health Emergency Centre (MHEC) admissions, this responsibility sits with the MHEC RMO**

- Completes formal admission paperwork
- Undertakes any required physical examinations.

Emergency Physician in Charge (EPiC)

- Provides a point of escalation for any patient issues/queries
- Final endorsement of patient discharge via the PMHS. This will involve review of notes, discussion of the plan with the PLN and signing off WebPSOLIS Triage notes (print version)
- Undertakes or delegates prescription for any medications required for patients being discharged
- Undertakes or delegates completion of EDIS discharge letters and discharge from EDIS (can be delegated to Pod Leader/Nursing) as required.

Waiting room nurse

- Supports the Triage Nurse to complete the PPMHS Tool for all patients who present with a primary mental health condition and are triaged as an ATS 4 or 5

EMHS Mental Health Patient Flow Coordinator (0700 – 1700hrs) and the Operations Hub Coordinator (OHC) (1700 – 0700hrs)

- Coordinates mental health inpatient ward placements in partnership with the ED and Psychiatry clinical teams
- Liaises with EMHS and external mental health inpatient sites to obtain appropriate ward placement, facilitates referral distribution and follow-up within agreed patient flow framework timelines – refer [Mental Health Patient Flow and Bed Capacity Framework](#)
- Reports to RPBG Clinical and Executive teams on ED mental health capacity and demand through the Mental Health BRAG system and ED Capacity and Demand Code Yellow system.

Compliance monitoring

Compliance monitoring of the following metrics will be undertaken by the ED Head of Department (HoD) and Nurse Unit Manager (NUM)

- Number of patients who meet the criteria of the PMHS
- Number of patients who utilise the PMHS
- WEAT compliance for patients who utilise the PMHS, all mental health patients and all ED patients
- Clinical incidents reported via the Clinical Incident Management System (CIMS) & Consumer Feedback for patients in PMHS
- Patient experience quality measures (e.g. YES survey).

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Facilitator

Jessica Casado, Divisional Safety & Quality Coordinator, HoLAA

Authors / acknowledgements

We acknowledge the following previous site endorsed work and/or contributors used to compile this document.

Dr Jessamine Soderstrom, Deputy HoD, ED, RPH

Review authors

Dr Gareth Humphreys, HoD, ED, RPH

Sarah-Louise Laing, Coordinator of Nursing, HoLAA, RPBG

James MacWatt, A/Co-Director, HoLAA, RPBG

Michelle De Silva, Coordinator of Nursing, Mental Health, RPH

Chris McCavana, Operations Hub Manager, RPBG

Dr Vinesh Gupta, Medical Co-Director, Mental Health

Related policies, practice standards, clinical guidelines

[RPBG Policy Hub](#)

- Admission, Transfer and Discharge SOP
- Inpatient Admissions from the ED Policy
- Mental Health Unit (MHU) Referral, Admission, Discharge and Transfer Policy
- Ward 2K Referrals and Admission Guidelines (Mental Health)
- Mental Health Emergency Centre Referral, Admission, Discharge and Transfer Policy
- Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration (RRAD) in Mental State, Cognition and Behaviour SOP
- ED Triage and Waiting Room SOP

[EMHS Policy Hub](#)

- Mental Health Patient Flow and Bed Capacity Framework

Related Forms

- Primary Mental Health Stream Provisional Medical Clearance

Related National Standards

ACSQHC NSQHS Standards 2nd Edition (2021)

Standard 1: Clinical Governance

Standard 6: Communicating for Safety

Standard 8: Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration

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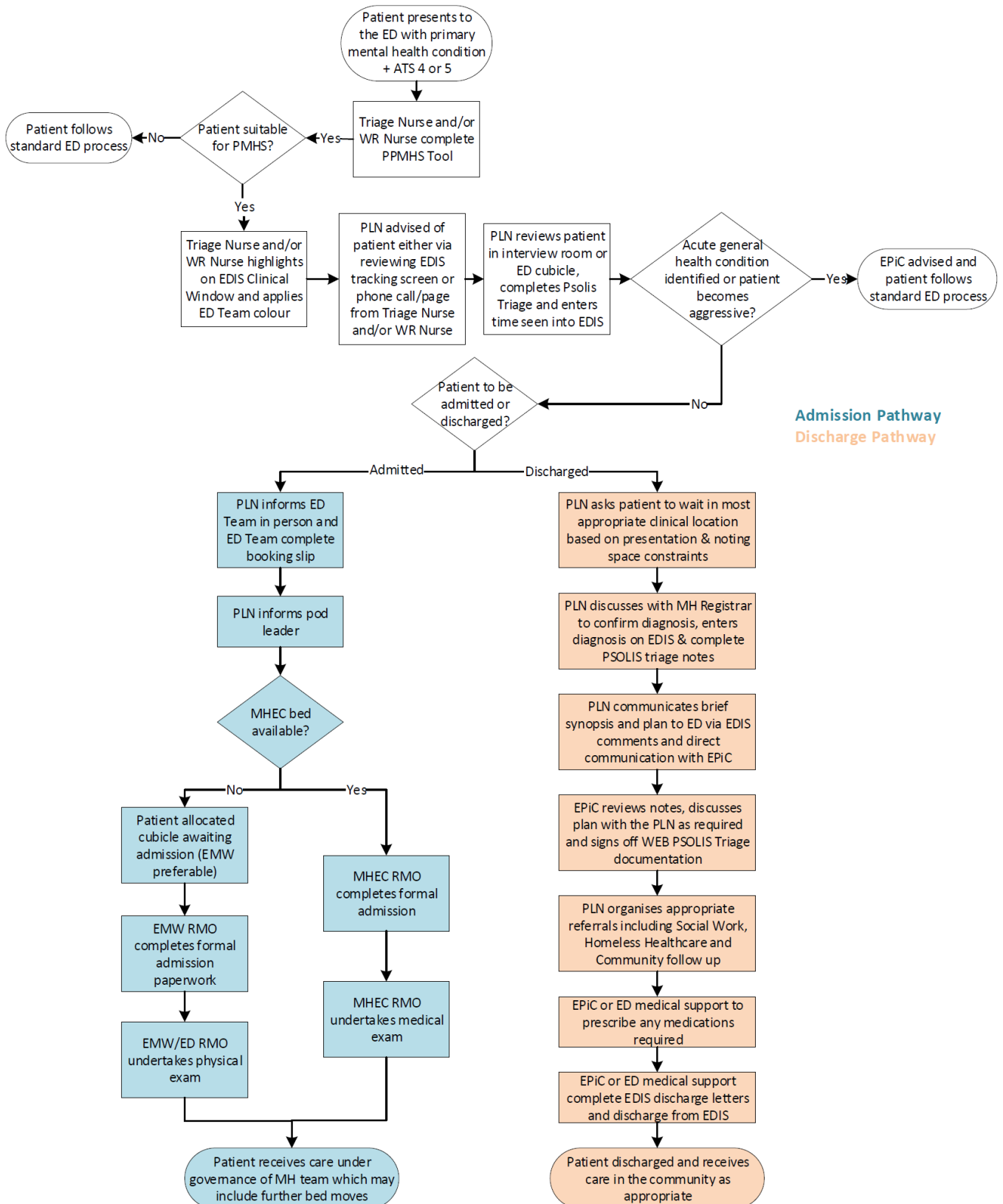
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Appendix I: Primary Mental Health Stream Pathway



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